

Filter & Legend Automation Plugin

Installation & Usage Guide | Internal Team Documentation

Overview

This pyRevit extension automates color-coded presentation drawings. It replaces the manual process of creating view filters and legends one at a time with two one-click tools:

- **Create Filter** – batch-creates view filters and applies color overrides for foundation, column, and wall types in the active view.
- **Legend from Filters** – automatically builds a matching legend from those filters in the project's Legend view.

Use this guide to install the extension and run both tools correctly on your projects.

Requirements

- Autodesk Revit 2021 or later
- pyRevit installed (download: pyrevitlabs.io)
- Access to the plugin repository / shared folder provided by the BIM team

Installation

Step 1 – Get the extension files

Download or clone the extension folder named **AAtools.extension** from the shared repository. Make sure the full folder structure stays intact:

```
AAtools.extension /  
  AAtools.tab /  
    Presentation.panel /  
      Create Filter.pushbutton /  
      Legendfromfilters.pushbutton /
```

Step 2 – Place the extension in pyRevit's extensions folder

Copy the entire **AAtools.extension** folder into your pyRevit extensions directory, typically located at:

```
%appdata%\pyRevit\Extensions
```

You can open this folder quickly by pasting the path above into File Explorer's address bar.

Step 3 – Register the extension in pyRevit (alternative method)

If you prefer not to manually copy files, you can register the extension directly from Revit:

- Open Revit, go to the **pyRevit** tab → **Settings** → **Custom Extensions**.

- Click + **Add Folder** and select the folder containing **AAtools.extension**.
- Save settings.

Step 4 – Reload pyRevit

- Go to the **pyRevit** tab in Revit → click **Reload**.
- If the panel doesn't appear, fully restart Revit.

Once reloaded, a new ribbon tab named **AAtools** will appear with a **Presentation** panel containing two buttons: **Create Filter** and **Legend from Filters**.

Points to Keep in Mind

- The legend name must not contain curly brackets ({ }). Using curly brackets in the legend name will cause the tool to fail.
- At least one legend view must already exist in the project before running **Legend from Filters** — the tool works by duplicating an existing legend, so it cannot run in a project with zero legends.
- If a filter already exists in the view, **Create Filter** will skip it rather than duplicating or overwriting it.

Maintained by Shubham, BIM Engineering team. For issues or feature requests, reach out directly or raise them in the shared project channel.